

ACLS

ACLS N/A

Hold **\$187.53 ▲ 6.89%** 12M Price Target **\$195.00** 52-Week Range **\$64.62 – \$193.78**

Market Cap
\$5.76B

ACLS: Riding the Chip Equipment Wave to New Highs

WHAT'S CHANGED

- Stock jumped almost 7% yesterday to \$187.53, riding a huge tech sector rally (+3% on the day) — the whole semiconductor equipment group is on fire as investors bet the chip downturn is finally over.
- ACLS is now sitting at 95% of its 52-week range (\$64-\$194), meaning it's basically a stone's throw from its yearly high after more than doubling off the lows.

IMPLICATIONS

This isn't really an ACLS-specific story — it's a sector-wide melt-up in chip equipment names as money rotates aggressively into tech. The "golden cross" signal from earlier this month (when the 50-day average crosses above the 200-day, a classic momentum buy signal) is now playing out. The catch: with the stock up ~190% from the lows in under a year, a lot of good news is already priced in, and you're buying late in the move.

VALUATION

At ~\$5.8B market cap on roughly \$850M of expected revenue, you're paying about 7x sales — not crazy for semi equipment, but well above where ACLS traded historically (3-4x). On earnings, it's around 45x forward — meaning investors are paying \$45 for every \$1 of profit, which assumes the cycle keeps ripping. Fair value is probably \$180-200; meaningful upside requires actual orders accelerating, not just multiple expansion.

KEY RISKS

- China exposure — ACLS has historically gotten 40%+ of revenue from China, and any new export restrictions from Washington would hit them hard and fast.
- The chip equipment business is brutally cyclical — when memory and power semi customers cut orders (like they did in 2024), revenue can drop 30%+ in a year.
- That weird institutional ownership number (1.1%) looks like a data glitch given BlackRock alone owns 16%, but the put/call ratio at 1.23 (more bearish bets than bullish) and an unusual \$190 put buy suggests some big players are hedging this rally.

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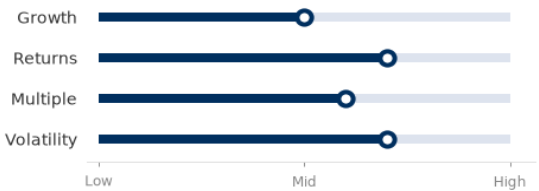
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Key Data

Price (USD)	\$187.53
12M Price Target	\$195.00
Upside / (Downside)	+4.0%
Market Cap	\$5.76B
FY2026E Revenue	\$850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$1,020M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.20
FY2027E EPS	\$5.60
Fwd P/E	44.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$205.00	\$190.00	\$170.00
6 Months	\$230.00	\$200.00	\$155.00
1 Year	\$260.00	\$210.00	\$140.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$240.00	\$130.00
5 Years	\$450.00	\$300.00	\$120.00
10 Years	\$700.00	\$425.00	\$100.00

SECTOR INTELLIGENCE

HEATING UP: Tech (especially semiconductors and chip equipment), Consumer Discretionary, Industrials

COOLING OFF: Real Estate, Communication Services

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flooding into tech (+4.5% over 5 days) and out of defensive plays like real estate and dividend names. Classic "risk on" behavior — investors are betting the Fed is done tightening and growth is reaccelerating, so cyclical winners like chip equipment makers are the favored trade.

RELATED PLAY: If the semi cap equipment rally has legs, look at AMAT (Applied Materials), LRCX (Lam Research), and KLAC (KLA Corp) — they're the bigger, more diversified plays. Amkor (AMKR) was mentioned in the news flow as a packaging/assembly play that benefits from the same trend.

OUTPERFORMERS & PEER CONTEXT

- AMAT (Applied Materials): Riding the same chip equipment recovery wave with broader product exposure than ACLS.
- LRCX (Lam Research): Benefiting from memory chip recovery — directly correlated to ACLS's customer base coming back online.

ACLS CONTEXT: ACLS is actually LEADING this group off the lows because it got hit harder on the way down — classic high-beta cyclical bounce. But that also means it'll fall faster if sentiment flips.

INVESTMENT STRATEGY

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the cycle turning but hate chasing a stock that just doubled; timing matters here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% of portfolio — small enough that a 20% drawdown doesn't wreck you, big enough to matter if the cycle has another leg up.

ENTRY POINTS: Don't chase \$187. Wait for a pullback to \$170-175 (the recent support zone), or scale in 1/3 now, 1/3 at \$175, 1/3 at \$160.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months to ride the chip cycle recovery — these cycles typically run 18-24 months once they start.

WHEN TO BAIL: If China restrictions tighten meaningfully, if quarterly bookings disappoint, or if the stock breaks below \$160 on heavy volume (that would signal the rally is broken).

HEDGING: Consider buying a \$180 protective put for ~\$8 — costs you about 4% but caps your downside if this whole thing rolls over. Or pair-trade by shorting a pricier semi equipment name against your ACLS long.